

nectivity now extends to the Apple ecosystem, allowing the Pad 8 to function as an extended display for Mac users.

However, one gap that stands out is that there is no fingerprint sensor. The face unlock relies on basic 2D recognition, which Android does not classify as a secure biometric. On a tablet at this price, positioned for productivity, that absence is a notable omission.

XIAOMI PAD 8 REVIEW: BATTERY

The 9,200 mAh battery is the standout specification, particularly given the 5.75 mm chassis. In use, the Pad 8 handles a full day of mixed streaming, productivity, and gaming without concern and extends comfortably into a second day on lighter loads. In the PCMark battery life test, the Pad 8 ran through 12 hours and 39 minutes of continuous use which is great considering the screen size. Users can get more battery life by keeping the brightness in check. Xiaomi includes a 67 W charger in the box, and a full charge from empty takes 1 hour and 19 minutes.

XIAOMI PAD 8 REVIEW: AUDIO

The quad-speaker setup with Dolby Atmos and a 200% volume boost mode delivers clear, room-filling sound. It holds up well at higher volumes without noticeable distortion. For media consumption, the Pad 8 performs as well as anything in the Android tablet segment at this price.

XIAOMI PAD 8 REVIEW: CAMERAS

The camera hardware is unchanged from the Pad 7: a 13 MP rear sensor and an 8 MP front camera. The rear camera handles document scanning capably and produces acceptable results in good light, but it is not a replacement for a smartphone camera. The front camera is adequate for video calls, with natural colour output and reasonable sharpness. The landscape-mode camera placement means you can just prop it up on a table and you don't have to



worry about your chin showing up in office meetings.

XIAOMI PAD 8 REVIEW: ACCESSORIES

The Focus Pen Pro (Rs 5,999) gets the most notable redesign in the Pad 8 ecosystem. The physical buttons are replaced by haptic gestures: a double press, a pinch and a grip each trigger distinct functions. It is a cleaner design that feels more intuitive in use and the haptic feedback is precise enough to feel deliberate. For note-taking and sketching, the Focus Pen Pro is a meaningful step forward from its predecessor.

The Focus Keyboard Pro (Rs 8,999) is backlit with a base stable enough to use on the lap and the trackpad supports laptop-style gestures, so there's no learning curve. It handles light writing and browsing without complaint. The combined weight is worth factoring in though: the tablet at 485 g and the keyboard at 325 g total 810 g, putting the full setup in lightweight laptop territory. The keyboard's weight is necessary for stability, so this is an understood trade-off rather than a design flaw, but buyers should assess it against their portability needs before committing to the bundle.

VERDICT

The Xiaomi Pad 8 improves on the Pad 7 in the areas that matter most. The Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 brings performance up to a flagship level, the battery is larger and charges quickly and the form factor is the most refined Xiaomi has shipped in this segment. The HyperOS 3, based on Android 16 is a polished, capable operating system and the AI tools adds great value for work users and even designers.

The gaps are real but not deal-breakers for most buyers. The combined weight of the tablet-plus-keyboard system approaches that of a lightweight laptop. And while Android's app ecosystem has improved substantially, some third-party applications and UI inconsistencies still need to be addressed. That Xiaomi already includes a fingerprint sensor on the Pad 8 Pro makes the omission here a deliberate cost decision rather than a hardware limitation and a difficult one to justify at this price.

At the launch price of Rs 33,999 (which is now increased by Rs 2000) for the 8 GB + 128 GB variant and Rs 36,999 for the 12 GB + 256 GB, the Pad 8 is a strong recommendation for students, professionals who need a capable portable work device and anyone seeking the best Android tablet experience short of an iPad. The Focus Pen Pro and Focus Keyboard Pro are competitively priced for first-party accessories, but both are optional additions and should be evaluated against individual use cases.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 | RAM: 8/12 GB | Storage: 128/256/256 GB | Display: 11.2-inch 3.2K LCD panel | Refresh Rate: 144 Hz | Camera (Rear): 13 MP | Camera (Front): 8 MP | Battery: 9200 mAh | Charging: 45W | OS: Xiaomi HyperOS 3

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